



Where Founders Flourish And Companies Scale



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The \$29.7B Cost of Ignoring Mental Health

The Founder Crucible

100% of founders face extreme stress, but **0%** are trained to handle it. Why do we glorify survival instead of empowering success?

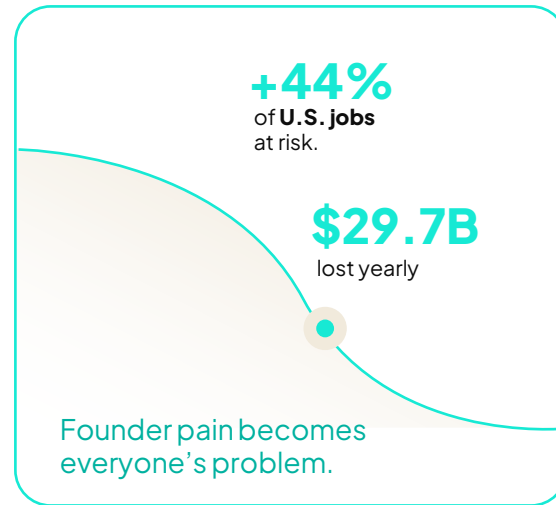
Teams



employees
burns out.

Stressed leaders create
broken teams.

Economy



The Silent Crisis

- **38%** of founders face serious mental health disorders.
- Crushing pressure isn't a badge of honor; it's a warning sign.

Families

- **70%** of founders lose relationships. 20% divorce.

Sacrifice shouldn't be a business strategy.

The Breaking Point

- **49%** of founders are one bad day from quitting.

We glorify "the grind" but ignore the cost:
burned-out leaders, stalled innovation,
and a weaker economy.



A Proactive Model for Founder Flourishing

The Solution

Healthy Founders  14% higher exits. The math is simple. The solution is here.



Prevention First

12–18 Months of Support

Coaching, therapy, and peer networks, designed for resilience, not just survival.

Impact

+25% team productivity and **+14%** successful exits



Cultural Rewiring

240 VC Firms

Now include mental health in term sheets.

New Standard

Well-being is as non-negotiable as revenue growth.



Science-Backed Resilience

Partnerships

Stanford and UCSF frameworks cut burnout by **40%**.

Mental Gym

Training focus, decision-making, and emotional agility.



240 VCs, 30,000 Startups, and a Cultural Shift

The Movement in Motion

What began as a whisper about founder struggles is now a roar, backed by **30,000** startups and the biggest names in tech.

240 VC Firms & Accelerators

(YC, Techstars, General Catalyst) now prioritize mental health across **30,000** startups.

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15 Institutional VCs

have hardwired mental health into term sheets.

Teams

Andy Dunn

Eric Ries

Brad Feld

Aaron Gershenberg

Andrew Johns

Maëlle Gavet

Linda Rottenberg

are leading a cultural reboot

Well-being isn't soft—it's strategic.

Result

Mental health is now framed as a **competitive advantage**, not a taboo.



Seasoned Leaders Scaling the Movement

Meet Our Team

Jason Cavnar & Cristina Poindexter

Why It Matters

Proven leaders turning momentum into lasting impact.



Joined in late 2024

Brought together decades of experience in mental health and philanthropy.

Strategic Impact

Leveraging their leadership and networks to expand research, mobilize capital, and maximize the movement's reach.



Key Priority 1 Engaging VCs in the Movement

Scaling the Movement

Why VCs Matter

VCs are uniquely positioned to lead by example in prioritizing mental health.

Stage	What	Why
Pledge Commitment	Sign the Founder Mental Health Pledge.	Prioritize mental health as a core business value.
Clause Integration	Adopt the Founder Flourishing Clause in term sheets.	Ensure portfolio companies dedicate resources to mental health.
Championing Change	Become active champions by funding and encouraging well-being initiatives.	Drive a cultural shift within the startup ecosystem.
Invest in Performance & Research	Engage in a new initiative to fund performance and research in mental health.	Model the change and gather data on how well-being improves outcomes.

Collaborative Efforts

- Partnering with Founder Startup Snapshot for ecosystem data.
- Working with the National Venture Capital Association to broaden the impact.



Key Priority 2

The \$5M Founder Flourishing Fund

Element	Details
Fund Goal	Raise \$5M to invest directly in founder well-being.
Investment per Founder	\$20,000 allocated to each of 200 founders who have reached product-market fit.
Purpose of Investment	\$20,000 allocated to each of 200 founders who have reached product-market fit.
Benefits	Develop resilience, mental clarity, high-performance habits; drive long-term business success.
Fund Breakdown	\$4M for direct investments; \$1M for operations, administration, and landmark research coordination.



Key Priority 3

Transformational Research

Our Mission

Partner with top universities to answer one question

Do healthy founders actually build better companies?

Our Goal

Prove

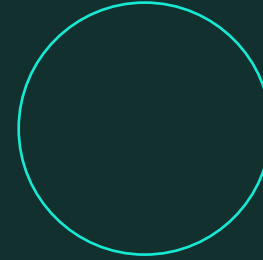
Founders who invest in mental health see:

Higher
Valuations

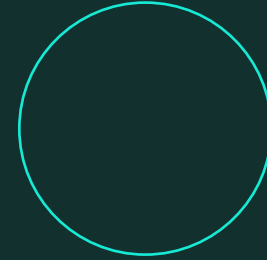
Faster
Scaling

Better
Exits

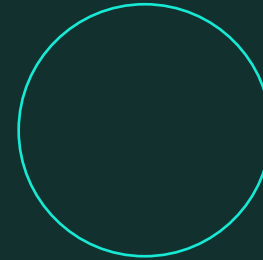
Key Research Partners



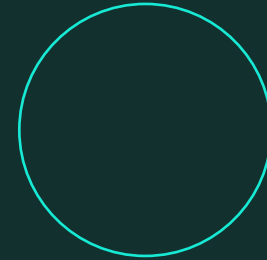
Dr. Jack Kreindler
(Well Founded)



Dr. Michael Freeman
(UCSF)



Dr. Ute Stephan
(King's College)



Econa
(Stanford-affiliated research)

Persuade

Make mental health as non-negotiable for VCs as financial due diligence



Key Priority 4

Championing the Movement

Component	Key Actions
Regional Ambassador Network	• Host VIP dinners, panels, and community events. • Secure local funding for the Founder Flourishing Fund. • Connect founders with well-being providers.
AI & Automation for Awareness	• Expand the reach of the Founder Pledge and Term Sheet Clause. • Automate resource and engagement processes for founders at scale.
Media & Thought Leadership	• Organize high-profile podcast appearances with top industry leaders. • Run ongoing PR campaigns (via CultureSpeed). • Launch the Founder Flourishing newsletter & podcast. • Develop media partnerships with TechCrunch, TheInformation, FastCompany, and Startup Snapshot.
Activating the Coaches Community	• Deputize coaches to represent the Founder Mental Health Pledge at events and podcasts. • Leverage their networks to scale the movement.



Partnering With VC & Founder Training Organizations

Partner Category	Examples	Purpose
VC Accelerators	Kauffman Fellows, ScreenDoor, VC Lab, Dream VC, Venture University, The VC Factory, 500 Global's Venture Education, GoingVC.	Accelerate founder growth through targeted VC training.
Universities	Stanford (StartX, Stanford GSB), Harvard (Harvard Innovation Labs, Rock Center for Entrepreneurship), MIT (Martin Trust Center), Berkeley (Berkeley Haas, SkyDeck), University of Pennsylvania (Wharton Entrepreneurship, Penn Center), University of Chicago, Northwestern, Columbia, Yale, University of Michigan, Duke, Babson, UT Austin, USC, Carnegie Mellon, Rice, University of Washington, Indiana University, Cornell, University of Virginia.	Educate and shape the next generation of founder talent.
Accelerators & Venture Studios	Y Combinator, Techstars, 500 Global, Plug and Play, Alchemist Accelerator, SOSV, StartX, AngelPad, Pioneer, Launch Accelerator, Antler, ERA, Forum Ventures, Gener8tor, MassChallenge, Berkeley SkyDeck, NFX, Founders Factory, Boost VC, Venture Lane, Outlier Ventures, Atomic, Human Capital, Science Inc., Betaworks, High Alpha, Village Global, Expa, AlleyCorp, Launch House, The Fund, Republic Venture Studio, Future Ventures Studio, HVF Labs, Prehype, Giant Ventures, Builders VC.	Engage with pre-seed founders early and leverage network effects.

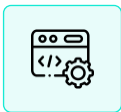


Partnering With Sponsors



Service Providers

- Law Firms, Banks, Financial Services, Wealth Management Firms
 - Supporting legal, financial, and strategic needs.
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Software Providers

- Mercury Bank, Stripe, Hubspot, Notion, Twilio
- Enabling efficient operations and digital infrastructure.



Corporate Foundations & Sponsors

- Salesforce, Google, Autodesk
 - Driving large-scale impact through strategic partnerships.
-



Philanthropists & Family Foundations

- Bringing passion and resources to support founder well-being.



Mental Health

The Silent Multiplier in Tech's Growth

The Lean Startup didn't just change how startups build products, it changed how the world innovates.

Founder well-being is the next evolution.

Why It Matters to Investors

Protect Your Exits

Burnout forces founders to quit. Resilience keeps them building, and exits growing.

Talent Magnet

Healthy leaders attract top talent, outpace competitors, and dominate markets.

The Bigger Picture

Founders shape corporate norms.

Resilient founders



Resilient companies



Resilient economies

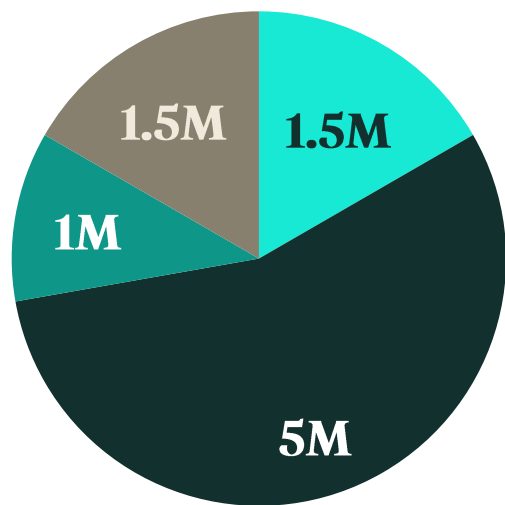
This is how we turn **\$29.7B** in losses into **\$29.7B** in growth.



Strategic Funding Scalable Impact

Funding Amount (USD)

Total Raise: \$9M



■ Full-Time Team (Operating Funds)
■ Founder Flourishing Fund
■ The Longevity Study

Initiative	Purpose
Full-Time Team (Operating Funds)	Build a dedicated team to drive advocacy, execute the Founder Flourishing Fund, manage research, and engage the community.
Founder Flourishing Fund	Direct investments in founder well-being, supporting 20 founders in the first cohort.
The Longevity Study	Conduct landmark research to track business outcomes linked to founder well-being.
Unrestricted Funds	Cover operations, travel, meals, and expenses for scaling the movement.



Invest in the Future of Founders

Turn **\$9M** into

\$29.7B of Economic Growth.



Your Impact

● **5M** funds **200 founders** with coaching, therapy, and resilience tools.

● **1M** proves to investors that founder well-being equals **14%** higher exits.

● **1.5M** scales the movement to **2X** VC adoption by 2026.



In **10 years**, founder well-being will be as standard as cloud hosting, making our advocacy unnecessary.

Join our **\$9M** round

and shape a healthier, more profitable future for founders and investors alike.

